Course-End Project

Streamlining Banking Support Operations through Agile and BMC

Overview

This course-end project guides you in applying Agile methodology and Business Model Canvas (BMC) to streamline post-trade operations at a global investment bank. The objective is to optimize support operations for more than 120 applications by relocating support from offshore-only to a mixed-shore model. By applying Agile principles and BMC's nine building blocks, learners will enhance process efficiency and drive early value delivery.

You will:

- Develop and simulate Agile release strategies to track and improve support workflows.
- Apply the nine elements of the Business Model Canvas to the banking support ecosystem.
- Document Epics and User Stories using Jira and follow the INVEST principle.
- Identify root causes using Fishbone diagrams.
- Design mockups and workflows that visualize an optimized support process.
- Build customer personas and To-Be Experienced Map based on stakeholder needs.

This project helps you experience how Agile and business modeling frameworks lead to faster insights, better planning, and sustainable transformation in financial services.

Instructions

- Review Agile delivery concepts, BMC components, and business process modeling tools
- Use JIRA to track Epics and Stories with proper acceptance criteria
- Create diagrams and design mockups using Figma
- Present all artifacts in a structured document with screenshots and narratives

Scenario

The investment bank is undergoing a three-year finance transformation but expects visible results within the first few quarters. Your team must plan and deliver a structured Agile release strategy while applying business modeling principles. The support model must be redefined to reduce cost, enhance service delivery, and improve operational transparency.

Current pain points include:

- Dispersed and undocumented support procedures
- Limited stakeholder visibility into progress and outcomes
- Redundancy and inefficiency in application support ownership
- Minimal integration of design thinking into support design

You are tasked to co-develop a solution using Agile and BMC that maps the future state and facilitates smoother handoffs, lean workflows, and improved visibility.

Task

Task 1: Create Business Model Canvas

- Complete the 9 BMC blocks:
    - Customer segments
    - Value propositions
    - Channels
    - Customer relationships
    - Revenue streams
    - Key resources
    - Key activities
    - Key partnerships
    - Cost structure
- Use real project inputs to populate each area with insights

Task 2: Capture requirements in Jira

- Create a Jira project
- Add Epics per functional domain (for example, Knowledge Transfer, Reporting, Resource Alignment)
- Add INVEST-compliant user stories under each epic
- Define acceptance criteria and priorities
- Share screenshots of JIRA boards, backlogs, and stories

Task 3: Fishbone Diagram for Root Cause Analysis

- Identify the core challenge (for example, delayed support resolution)
- Map root causes under categories: people, process, tools, environment
- Share the final diagram image

Task 4: To-be Experienced Maps

- Build 2–3 personas (for example, onshore Lead, offshore agent, stakeholder)
- Develop To-Be Experience Maps: desired actions, thoughts, emotions, and touchpoints
- Connect maps to design and process insights

Task 5: Design wireframes

- Identify key touchpoints (for example, support dashboard, escalations tracker)
- Use tools like Figma, Lucidchart, Canva
- Annotate UI elements and user actions

Action

You are expected to submit:

1. Jira screenshots:
    - Epics, stories, acceptance criteria
    - Sprint and release planning boards
2. BMC Canvas:
    - Full canvas showing real analysis per block
3. Visual diagrams:
    - Fishbone diagrams

    - Data flow or wireframe mockups or both
4. Stakeholder mapping:
    - Personas with To-Be Experience Map
5. Agile artifacts:
    - Release roadmap and sprint delivery matrix

Result

Submit a single document (Word or PDF) that includes:

- Agile strategy with sprint breakdown and milestones
- JIRA screenshots and documented User Stories
- Business Model Canvas with insight narratives
- Root cause diagrams
- Wireframe designs with key annotations
- Stakeholder personas and To-Be Experienced Map
- Summary of key recommendations
- Reflection (4–5 lines) on the use of Agile and BMC for process redesign

By completing this project, you will demonstrate how Agile methodology and business model frameworks enable faster, collaborative, and customer-aligned transformation. Your submission will reflect your understanding of iterative delivery, structured planning, and real-world stakeholder engagement.